

Building your own SQE1 revision tools with Claude

A COLP student's set-up guide — for the January sitting

You have COLP's SLK manuals, H5P quizzes, Progress Tasters and mock exams. That is a lot of PDF. The problem is not access to material — it's that reading a 300-page manual for the third time doesn't move your score.

This guide gets you three tools built by Claude, from your own COLP files:

1. **A High-Yield companion** — every SLK chapter compressed to one screen of memorisable lines, plus mind maps and decision trees.
2. **A mock exam engine** — your COLP question banks turned into a timed, 180-question exam interface.
3. **A flashcard deck that builds itself** from every question you get wrong.

They are all single HTML files. You open them by double-clicking. No coding.

Time to build: one weekend for the first version, then ~20 minutes a week to keep it fed.

Part 0 — Set-up (do this first, ~30 minutes)



Book the exam, if you haven't. Registration for the January 2027 sitting opens **8 September 2026** and closes **20 November 2026**. The assessment window is **11-22 January 2027**, results **8 March 2027**. London centre slots go early — book the day registration opens.



Download the Claude desktop app from claude.ai/download. You want the desktop app, not the website — it's the one that can read and write files on your computer.



Subscribe to a paid plan. The free tier will run out mid-task. Max is worth it if you're building all three tools in one go; Pro is fine if you build over a few weekends.



Make one folder on your computer called `SQE1`. Everything lives here.



Inside it, make three subfolders: `Manuals`, `Mock exams`, `Tests`.



Put your COLP files in. All SLK manuals as PDF in `Manuals`. Anything you've sat — Progress Tasters, mocks, H5P quiz exports — in `Mock exams` or `Tests`.



Open Cowork in the Claude desktop app and connect the SQE1 folder. This is the step that matters. Once connected, Claude can read your manuals directly instead of you pasting text.



Get COLP's examinable law updates too. They issue separate update documents per subject (e.g. "Examinable law update Dispute Resolution"). The January 2027 sitting runs on a revised specification, so a manual dated mid-2026 may be out of date in places. Put the update docs in `Manuals` alongside the PDFs and tell Claude: *"Where an examinable law update contradicts the manual, the update wins — and flag it in the notes so I know it changed."*

Naming tip that will save you pain later: keep COLP's original file names (`SLK LAND4 manual 2026_05_21.pdf`). The subject code and the date in the filename are how Claude works out which manual is which. Don't rename them to "Land Law.pdf".

Part 1 — The High-Yield companion

What it is: one HTML file with a chapter for every section of every SLK manual. Each chapter is a page of one-line memorisable points — not prose. Plus mind maps and decision trees drawn as HTML, so you can see the structure of a topic instead of reading about it.

Why it beats re-reading the manual: the manual teaches. This revises. Different jobs.

Step 1.1 — Build the skeleton



Start a new chat in Cowork with the `SQE1` folder connected and paste:

I'm sitting SQE1 in January. I have the College of Legal Practice SLK manuals as PDFs in the Manuals folder.

Read the contents pages of every manual and build me a single self-contained HTML file called SQE1_HighYield.html.

Structure:

- A left-hand sidebar listing every subject, expandable to show each numbered section (e.g. 4.1, 4.2, 4.3) exactly as numbered in the manual.
 - A main pane that shows the selected section.
 - A search box that filters sections by title and by body text.
 - Everything inline in the one file - no external CSS, JS or fonts.
- I need to be able to open it offline.

Store the content as a JavaScript array of section objects at the top of the file, like this:

```
{
  id: "4.2",
  title: "Freehold Covenants",
  content: "...",
  visuals: [],
  cases: []
}
```

For now leave content, visuals and cases empty. I just want the skeleton with the correct section numbering. Tell me how many sections you found.



Check the section numbers against your manuals before going further. If the numbering is off, every later step inherits the error. This is the single most expensive mistake to fix late.

Step 1.2 — Fill in the content, one subject at a time

Do **not** ask for all subjects at once. Claude will run out of room and quietly thin the later ones. One subject per message.



For each subject, paste this (swapping the manual name):

Fill in the content for every section of SLK LAND4.

Rules for the writing - these matter more than anything else:

- These are memorisation notes, not explanation. Assume I have already read the manual.
- ONE POINT PER LINE. No paragraphs. No "it is important to note that".
- Aim for 15,000-20,000 characters per section. If you're writing less you're leaving out detail; if more, you're explaining rather than listing.
- Lead every rule with the trigger: what fact pattern makes this rule apply?
- Statutory sections and time limits go inline (s 2 LP(MP)A 1989, 12 years, 21 days). Numbers are what gets tested.
- Case names go in the `cases` array, NOT in the body text. The body should read as rules, not as case law commentary.
- Where two things are commonly confused, put them side by side and state the distinguishing test in one line.

Show me section 4.1 first so I can check the style before you do the rest.



Check 4.1. If it's written like a textbook, say **"too much explanation, cut it to bare rules"** and it will recalibrate for the whole subject.



Then: Good. Do the rest of LAND4 the same way.



Repeat for all 15 or so manuals. This is the long part — a few hours spread over a weekend.

Step 1.3 — Add the visuals

This is the step most people skip and it's the one that does the heavy lifting.



For each subject:

Now add visuals to every section of LAND4. Populate the `visuals` array.

Two types, rendered as HTML and CSS (no image files, no external libraries):

1. type: "map" - a mind map. Shape:

```
{ label: "Mind map - the five topics in 4.2",
  type: "map",
  centre: "4.2 FREEHOLD COVENANTS",
  branches: [ { label: "BURDEN AT LAW",
    leaves: ["Never passes (Austerberry)",
      "Workarounds: chain of indemnity",
      "s 79 LPA is word-saving only"] } ] }
```
2. type: "branch" - a decision tree for anything with a test sequence.
Each node is a yes/no question with the outcome at each exit.

Rules:

- Every section gets at least one map covering the whole section, plus a map per major topic within it.
- Leaves are keywords and section numbers, not sentences.
- Anything that works as a sequence of gates - formalities, passing of burden and benefit, elements of a claim - becomes a decision tree.
- CAPITALISE branch labels so the structure reads at a glance.

Step 1.4 — Add the traps (build this in as you go)

Every time you sit a COLP quiz or taster and get something wrong, the wrong answer goes into the file.



Export or screenshot the feedback and:

Attached is my COLP Progress Taster feedback with the questions I got wrong. For each one:

1. Work out which section of the HighYield file it belongs to. COLP's feedback usually says "See 4.2.3" - use that.
2. Add a trap note at the relevant point in that section's content, marked with a warning symbol.
3. The note should name the distractor and say why it's wrong, in one or two lines: what I confused with what, and the one test that separates them.

Do not rewrite the section. Just insert the trap notes.

Part 2 — The mock exam engine

What it is: all of COLP's questions in one timed interface — 180 questions, flag-for-review, question navigator, a countdown clock, and a score at the end that tells you which sections you're weak in.

Why: SQE1 is 360 single-best-answer questions — FLK1 and FLK2, 180 each, sat on separate days. Each day is **two sessions of 90 questions, 2 hours 33 minutes per session**. That's 1 minute 40 seconds a question, sustained, for two half-days. Doing ten questions at a time in H5P does not prepare you for session two. The stamina is a separate skill from the law.

Step 2.1 — Extract the question bank



Put every mock, taster and quiz PDF into the `Mock exams` folder, then:

The Mock exams folder has my COLP mock exams and Progress Tasters as PDFs. Extract every question into a JSON file.

For each question capture: the full stem, all five options A-E, the correct answer, COLP's explanation, and the subject or section reference COLP gives in the feedback.

Watch for these - they will silently corrupt the bank:

- Options that wrap onto a second line get split into two separate options, and the last two options get merged. After extracting, check every question has exactly five options and flag any that don't.
- The same question appears in more than one PDF. Deduplicate on the first 60 characters of the question stem, not on the answer text - distractors often share long openings.
- Older PDFs sometimes carry an answer key COLP later corrected. Where two copies of the same question disagree on the answer, show me both and let me decide.

Report: total questions found, duplicates removed, and anything that failed the five-option check.



Actually read the failure list. A silently corrupt bank teaches you the wrong law, which is worse than not revising at all.

Step 2.2 — Build the exam interface

Build `SQE1_MockExam.html` - one self-contained file, everything inline, with the question bank embedded as a JavaScript array.

Features:

- Start screen: choose FLK1 or FLK2, choose number of questions (90 to replicate one real session, 180 for a full paper, or 30 for a quick drill), choose subject filter or all.
- Exam screen: one question at a time, five radio options, Next and Previous, a Flag for review button, and a question navigator grid showing answered / unanswered / flagged.
- A countdown timer set to the real rate: 2 hours 33 minutes per 90 questions (1 min 40 sec each), scaled to whatever length I pick. Show it, don't hide it. Getting used to the clock is the point.
- No feedback during the exam. Score only at the end.
- Results screen: overall score, a breakdown by subject, and a list of every question I got wrong with the stem, my answer, the correct answer and COLP's explanation.
- Save my score and my wrong answers to browser `localStorage` so I can see my history across sittings.

Step 2.3 — Set the pace



One full mock every two weeks from now until December, then one a week in January. Put them in your calendar now, at the actual exam time of day.



Sit them cold. No notes, no pausing the timer.

Part 3 — Flashcards that build themselves

What it is: every question you ever got wrong, turned into a flashcard, resurfaced until you stop getting it wrong.

Why: your wrong answers are the only genuinely personalised revision material you have. Everything else is the same material every other candidate has.

Add a flashcard mode to the mock exam file.

Every question I answer incorrectly becomes a flashcard - front is the stem, back is the correct answer plus the explanation plus the one-line reason my chosen distractor was wrong.

Important: unlike the exam bank, flashcards should NOT be deduplicated. If I get the same question wrong three times across three sittings, I want to see it three times. Repetition of my own errors is the signal.

Add a spaced repetition schedule: after each card I press Again / Hard / Good / Easy, and the interval adjusts. Cards I press Again on come back in the same session.

Store progress in localStorage.

Part 4 — The weekly loop (this is the actual method)

The tools are scaffolding. This is what makes the score move:



Monday: work through the week's COLP module as scheduled. Don't skip ahead.



Wednesday: 30 questions from the mock engine on last week's topic. Cold.



Wednesday, straight after: feed the wrong answers back into the High-Yield file as trap notes (Step 1.4). Ten minutes.



Friday: read only the High-Yield chapters for that week, plus the mind map. Not the manual.



Sunday: flashcard session — whatever the spaced repetition surfaces.



Every second Saturday: a full timed paper — 90 questions in 2h33 to start with, building to a full 180 (both sessions, one after the other) by November.

If a score goes down after you've revised a topic

This happens and it is alarming. It is almost always not a knowledge gap — it's a **discrimination failure**. You now know more rules, so more of them look plausible, and you're picking between two you can't yet separate.



The fix:

My score on [topic] went DOWN after revising it. I think I can't discriminate between the rules rather than not knowing them.

Rebuild this section as a sequence of gates. For each pair of rules I might confuse, give me the single question that separates them, in the order I should ask it. Then give me five questions where the only difference between the right answer and the best distractor is that one test.

Part 5 — Things that will go wrong

Learned the hard way. Read this before you start, not after.

Problem	What it looks like	Fix
Editing the wrong file	You have <code>v1</code> , <code>v2</code> , <code>v2_final</code> , and your edits vanish	Pick one filename and delete the rest. Tell Claude at the start of every chat: “only ever edit <code>SQE1_HighYield.html</code> ”
Silent truncation	You ask for all 15 subjects; subjects 1–4 are excellent, 12–15 are thin	One subject per message. Always. Spot-check the last one.
Answer key drift	A question’s “correct” answer is wrong and you learn the wrong rule	Cross-check anything that surprises you against the SLK manual before you believe it
No backups	One bad edit and 40 hours are gone	Before any big change: Make a dated backup copy of the file first. Or put the folder in Dropbox/iCloud with version history.
Content that reads like a textbook	Your “high-yield” notes are 8 pages per chapter	Say “too much explanation, cut to bare rules” — early, before it’s written 15 subjects that way
Nothing at all happens	Claude says it’s done but the file didn’t change	Check the file’s modified date. Ask: “Confirm the change is actually in the file — show me the line.”

The one thing to take from this

Don’t build all three at once. **Build the mock exam engine first** (Part 2), sit one, and let your wrong answers tell you which subjects need the High-Yield treatment. Building 15 subjects of beautiful notes for topics you’re already scoring 80% on is the most common way to waste a month.

Then, roughly:

- **Now → end of September:** mock engine built, sitting one every fortnight, High-Yield for your three weakest subjects only.
- **October → November:** High-Yield for everything else, keeping the fortnightly mocks.
- **December:** flashcards take over. Weekly mocks.
- **January:** mocks and flashcards only. No new content. Nothing new goes in after the first week of January.

Good luck.